

# DAY SHIFT

*A Force in the Food Service Labor Market*

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## The Problem Day Shift Actually Solves

Food service hiring is broken at every level:

**Workers:** Walk in, fill out a paper application, never hear back. Or download 5 different restaurant apps - each requiring full registration - just to find one shift.

**Kitchens:** Post on Indeed and get 200 applicants, 190 unqualified, 5 no-shows, and 3 quit by Friday. The owner spends 15 hours per week on hiring they cannot afford.

**The Middleman Gap:** There is no Tinder for kitchen crew. No trusted verification that someone actually knows how to handle a Friday night rush.

## Strategic Positioning

Day Shift sits at the intersection of four powerful forces reshaping the industry:

### 1. Labor Shortage

Hospitality cannot fill shifts. Turnover runs 70-80% annually across the industry.

### 2. Gig-ification

Workers expect flexibility now - not rigid 40-hour commitments.

### 3. Video-first Trust

A 30-second video tells a kitchen more about a candidate than any paper resume ever could.

### 4. Local + Mobile

The shift you need is usually within 3 miles. Proximity matters.

## The Economic Opportunity

The U.S. food service industry generates **\$900 billion in annual revenue** with **6+ million workers** and chronic staffing gaps that never close. Every unfilled shift costs a kitchen \$200-\$500 in lost revenue or overtime.

Day Shift does not need to capture the whole market - it needs to become the **default way** kitchens in Ohio (then the Midwest) find crew.

| Revenue Stream          | Model                  | Monthly Run Rate |
|-------------------------|------------------------|------------------|
| Kitchen Advertising     | 500 kitchens x \$50/mo | \$25,000         |
| Worker Premium Features | 5,000 workers x \$5/mo | \$25,000         |

|                             |                      |                     |
|-----------------------------|----------------------|---------------------|
| Certifications (ServSafe)   | Pure margin at scale | Unbounded           |
| <b>TOTAL (Conservative)</b> |                      | <b>\$600K+/year</b> |

## What Makes It a Force

| Weak Approach           | Strong Approach                                           |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Another job board       | Video-first verification - see the person before hiring   |
| Generalist / nationwide | Ohio-focused first - own one geography completely         |
| App for everything      | Shift-matching core - solve one thing perfectly           |
| Competing with Indeed   | Bypassing the middleman - direct worker to kitchen        |
| Hoping users come       | Kitchens bring their crews - network effect builds itself |

## The Path to Market Dominance

### 1. Own Ohio

Cleveland . Columbus . Cincinnati - become how kitchens there hire.

### 2. Certification as Moat

If Day Shift is where you get your ServSafe PIC cert, you are already in the ecosystem before you even look for work.

### 3. Shift-Matching Over Job Postings

"I need someone Friday 5pm" beats "we are hiring line cook" every time.

### 4. Then Expand

Adjacent states. Then national. One geography at a time.

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"Being a force means density. A matching platform dies without liquidity on both sides. Day Shift needs enough kitchens posting shifts AND enough workers browsing them that a match happens in under an hour, not under a week."

**The ServSafe certification feature is not a side product - it is distribution. Someone comes to Day Shift for a \$75 cert, now they have an account, now they are browsing shifts. That is the funnel.**

# The Bottom Line

**Yes - but as a regional utility built to last, not a unicorn chasing scale.**

Day Shift's real power is not the app. It is becoming the **default infrastructure** that connects Ohio's food service labor market - one verified video profile, one matched shift, one certification at a time.

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DAY SHIFT - Connecting Kitchens & Crew

Confidential Market Analysis